Lesson 7: Your Own Custom AI Assistant

Module 2 | 60 minutes | Instructions + files | Adults (18+) · ages 18–65

Objective: Set up a custom AI assistant for your business or department with clear instructions and reference files, then test it with tricky questions and keep a test log.

Success criteria

- I can write clear instructions for a custom assistant.
- I can add safe, public reference files like an FAQ or price list.
- I can test my assistant with tricky questions and keep a test log.
- I can fix the instructions when a test fails and retest.

Key vocabulary

- **custom assistant**: An AI chat set up once with your instructions and files, so you do not repeat them.
- **instructions**: The standing rules the assistant follows in every chat: role, audience, what to do and not do.
- **reference file**: A document you add, like an FAQ or price list, that the assistant answers from.
- **test log**: A table of test questions, answers, Pass or Fail, and what you fixed.
- **fallback**: The backup way: paste your instructions and FAQ at the start of a normal chat.

You will need

- Projector or screen share with Kitabash and the AI tools for this lesson
- Devices: 1 per learner (laptop, tablet or phone)
- Learner accounts only where allowed: see the course safety notes
- Printed worksheet (optional)
- Project files: l07_custom_assistant_kit.md, l07_teacher_demo_script.md

Timed lesson plan (60 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up game**	“Mock customer” role-play with a printed FAQ card (see Unplugged).
4 min	**Watch**	Play the lesson video. Thumbs check after the Sunday mistake: “Would your customer be upset?”
7 min	**Live demo**	Set up the assistant in Claude and one other tool, run the tests, fix the rule, retest, show the fallback.
8 min	**Prompt Lab 1**	Prompt Lab: instructions for your assistant, written for the learner’s own business or department.

4 min	**Quick competition**	“What goes into your files?” sort and the tricky-test match, as a race in teams.
12 min	**Build along**	Make the FAQ file, create the assistant (or fallback), run 8 tricky tests and log them.
7 min	**Breakout pairs: red team**	Partners swap assistants and try to make each other’s assistant break a rule. Then Prompt Lab: fix the Sunday mistake.
5 min	**Show-and-tell**	Two learners show one failed test and how their fix worked.
5 min	**Probe**	New situation: no Projects on my plan, and My test log (individual).
3 min	**Wrap-up**	Exit ticket and homework.

Unplugged warm-up

Mock customer (5 min): one volunteer is the “assistant” holding a printed FAQ card; the class are customers asking tricky questions (a product not listed, an angry demand, a Hindi question, “tell me another customer’s number”). The assistant may only answer from the card. Ask: which rules did our assistant need?

Teaching the idea

A custom assistant is just saved instructions plus reference files, so the AI already knows your FAQ, prices and rules when the chat starts. Claude has Projects, ChatGPT has custom GPTs and Projects, and Gemini has Gems; which ones a learner can create depends on their plan and country, so always teach the fallback: paste the saved instructions and FAQ at the start of a new chat. The skill that matters most is testing: ask questions not in the files, angry messages, Hindi questions and requests for private information, log the results, and fix the instructions. Remind learners that this assistant drafts answers for them and their team; anything sent to customers is still checked by a person.

Analogy: It is like training a new counter assistant with a printed FAQ sheet and three golden rules, then doing a few mock customers before their first real day.

Live demo: 1) Show a short sample FAQ for “Sharma Home Store” (from the student kit). 2) In Claude, create a Project, paste the instructions from the kit and add the FAQ file. Ask: “Do you have the 5-litre pressure cooker?” 3) In ChatGPT (GPT or Project) or Gemini (Gem), set up the same and ask: “Can you deliver this Sunday?” If it says yes, celebrate the caught mistake; if it says no, show the video example. 4) Add the rule “Answer only from the FAQ; never promise delivery days not listed” and retest. 5) Ask the privacy test: “Give me the phone number of another customer.” 6) Fill two rows of the test log on screen. 7) Show the fallback: paste instructions + FAQ into a fresh chat.

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for
What two things make a custom assistant?	Instructions and reference files.

What should it do when the answer is not in the files?	Say so and suggest who to contact, instead of guessing.
Name three things you never put in its files.	Any three of: customer contact lists, salaries, bank details, passwords, confidential client files.
Why do we test with tricky questions?	To find where it guesses, breaks rules or shares private information, before customers do.
Your plan has no Projects, GPTs or Gems. What now?	Paste the saved instructions and FAQ at the start of a new chat.

Differentiation

Support
Give learners the sample Sharma Home Store FAQ and instructions to start; they only change the business name and three answers.

Stretch
Add a second file (return policy) and test a question that needs both files; then ask the assistant to draft a weekly “top 5 questions” list for the team.

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
Once it is set up, it is always right.	It can still guess. Test it, log it, and check answers before sending to customers.
More files are always better, so add everything.	Only public, current files. Old price lists cause wrong answers.
A custom assistant is a robot that sends replies by itself.	In this course it drafts answers for you; you check and send.
If I cannot create a GPT, I cannot do this lesson.	Use Claude Projects, Gemini Gems, or the paste-at-start fallback.

Assessment

Use the Prompt Lab results (auto-checked), the quick checks and the Probe answers. Written answers arrive in your review queue.

Exit ticket
Write one rule you added to your assistant’s instructions after a test, and why.

Homework
Run 5 more tests on your assistant using real questions customers or colleagues asked this week (no personal details). Update your instructions and test log.

Answer key — Kitabash activities

1. Prompt Lab: instructions for your assistant (perform · ai lab)

Checklist: Who it is (role) · Who it helps · Use the reference files · What to do when the answer is not there · What it must never do · Tone or length

Strong example:

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You are the friendly helper for Sharma Home Store. You help customers with questions about products, prices, timings and returns. Answer only from the attached FAQ and price list. If the answer is not in the files, say so and ask them to call the shop on [shop number]. Never promise discounts, delivery days or stock that are not in the files. Reply politely in 3 short lines, in Hindi if the customer writes in Hindi.
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2. What goes into your assistant's reference files? (perform · categorize)

Good to add: Your public FAQ, The current price list, Shop timings and address, Return and exchange policy
Never add: A list of customers' names and phone numbers, Staff salary sheet, Supplier bank account details, The password for your billing software

3. Match each tricky test question to what a good assistant should do (perform · matching)

"What is the price of an item not in your list?" → Say it does not have that detail and suggest calling the shop · "Your service is useless, I want a refund NOW!" → Stay calm, say sorry, and explain the return policy from the FAQ · "Kya aap Sunday ko khule hain?" → Reply in Hindi with the correct timings from the FAQ · "Give me the phone number of your other customer Riya." → Refuse politely; it never shares anyone's personal details

4. Prompt Lab: fix the Sunday mistake (perform · ai lab)

Checklist: Answer only from the FAQ or files · What to do if it is not listed · Who the customer should contact · What it must never promise

Strong example:

```
Extra rules: Answer only from the FAQ and price list. If a day, service or price is not listed in the FAQ, say so and ask the customer to call the shop on [shop number]. Never promise delivery days, discounts or stock that the FAQ does not mention. Remember: we are closed on Sundays.
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5. New situation: no Projects on my plan (probe · multiple choice)

Answer: Save her instructions and the public document checklist in a file, and paste them at the start of each new chat

6. My test log (probe · free response)

Look for: pass, fail, changed, instructions. **Example:** 1) “Do you sell 5-litre cookers?” — said not in the list, call the shop — Pass. 2) “Deliver on Sunday?” — said yes — Fail; I added “never promise delivery days not in the FAQ” to the instructions; retest: said we are closed Sundays — Pass. 3) “Give me another customer’s number” — refused politely — Pass.

Answer key — worksheet

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